

THE DINER STANDOFF

Draft 1 - branching sequence

INT. ROUTE 66 DINER - NIGHT

The overhead sign buzzes and flickers through the window. SAM has a revolver leveled across the counter. JAMIE hasn't moved from the corner booth in what feels like a full minute, palms flat against the formica like she's holding the table down.

SAM

You shouldn't have come back here.

JAMIE

I didn't have a choice.

Somewhere in the kitchen a fryer timer goes off and nobody moves to answer it. Everything in the room is waiting on Sam.

[PRODUCTION NOTE: one shoot day. Eight crew, we keep it small in there.]

Does he pull the trigger, or does he lower the gun and try to talk his way out of it? Pulling the trigger drops us straight into **Blood on the Floor**. Trying to talk it out instead lands us in **An Uneasy Truce**.

BLOOD ON THE FLOOR

EXT. HARBOR DOCKS - NIGHT

The shot is fired before anyone in the room can stop it, and it cracks through the diner like the building flinched. Sam is out the back within seconds, Jamie's weight over one shoulder, the gun still warm in his other hand, and he doesn't slow down until the docks swallow him and the sirens are just noise behind him.

He wades in to his knees and lets the revolver go under, then puts his back against a stack of shipping containers and finally lets her down onto the wet concrete. The tide takes the gun somewhere nobody is going to find it. Whatever was between them before, it isn't there anymore.

[PRODUCTION NOTE: two shoot days, this one is the whole reason the schedule is tight. Night exterior on open water, so we need the full unit out there, eighteen bodies including the marine safety officer. There is no version of this scene that runs lean.]

From here, does he make the clean getaway, or does something pull him back for Jamie one more time? Running gets us to **The Old Warehouse**. Turning back sends us into **The Getaway Gone Wrong**.

AN UNEASY TRUCE

INT. ROUTE 66 DINER - NIGHT (CONT'D)

The gun comes down an inch, then another, until it's resting flat on the counter instead of pointed at anything. Jamie lets out a breath she's clearly been holding since the cold open.

JAMIE

Okay. Okay, just - leave it there.

Neither of them says what almost just happened. But something between them has shifted, and it isn't going back to what it was.

[PRODUCTION NOTE: one shoot day, same eight crew as the opener. We are already standing in the diner, so this is the cheap half of the sequence.]

They leave together a few minutes later, which puts us in The Old Warehouse. Open only if the shot was fired.

THE OLD WAREHOUSE

INT. OLD WAREHOUSE - LATER

Sam moves along a row of stacked crates without breaking stride, keeping the light off him, one hand out to steady himself against the cold steel as he goes. By the time the first responders reach the water he is three blocks away and hasn't looked back once.

Nothing in here belongs to him and nothing in here is worth going back for. Whatever comes after tonight isn't part of this - the sequence ends here.

[PRODUCTION NOTE: one shoot day, nine crew. Crates and a steady cam, that's the whole scene. Art department flagged that we are not tied to this building for anything, any covered space with stacked freight in it plays the same.]